Electrical Wiring Inspection Checklist (29 CFR 1910.305)

For site walk-throughs of cords, boxes, panels, temporary wiring and general-use electrical equipment.

OSHA 29 CFR 1910.305

DATE	SHIFT
INSPECTOR	AREA / EQUIPMENT ID

Before you start

1. Mark every item OK, Defect or N/A; use N/A only where the condition does not exist on site (for example, no temporary wiring or no wet locations).
2. For each Defect, record the location, what is wrong and the cited paragraph, and re-inspect the item once it has been corrected.
3. Each item cites the 1910.305 paragraph it checks; read the full paragraph for its exceptions and conditions.

Legal basis: 29 CFR 1910.305: Wiring methods, components, and equipment for general use (Part 1910 Subpart S: Electrical) Source: eCFR, Title 29, text as of 2026-11-09

Online version and sources: https://safetyindex.blog/us/standards/1910-305-wiring-methods-components-equipment-use

SECTION A | Flexible cords and cables

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
1	Cord suited to use and location Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(i)	Each cord is of a type approved for how and where it is being used.	☐	☐	☐	
2	Plug and receptacle supply Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iii)	Cords serving portable lamps or appliances have an attachment plug and are fed from an approved receptacle outlet.	☐	☐	☐	
3	No cords as fixed wiring Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iv)(A)	No cord is doing the job of the building's permanent wiring.	☐	☐	☐	
4	No cords through walls, ceilings or floors Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iv)(B)	No cord passes through a hole in a wall, ceiling or floor.	☐	☐	☐	
5	No cords through doorways or windows Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iv)(C)	No cord runs through a doorway, window or similar opening.	☐	☐	☐	
6	No cords fastened to the building Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iv)(D)	No cord is attached to walls, ceilings or other building surfaces.	☐	☐	☐	
7	No concealed cords Ref. 1910.305(g)(1)(iv)(E)	No cord is hidden behind walls, ceilings or floors.	☐	☐	☐	
8	Cord surface marking Ref. 1910.305(g)(2)(i)	On the cord types named in the clause, type designation, size and number of conductors are legible along the jacket at intervals not exceeding 610 mm (24 in.).	☐	☐	☐	
9	No splices or taps Ref. 1910.305(g)(2)(ii)	Cords are continuous lengths; any repair is on No. 14 or larger hard-service or junior hard-service cord and keeps the original insulation, sheath properties and usage characteristics.	☐	☐	☐	
10	Strain relief at plugs and fittings Ref. 1910.305(g)(2)(iii)	Plugs, connectors and fittings grip the cord so a pull on the cord does not reach joints or terminal screws.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION B | Boxes, cabinets and covers

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
11	Conductor entry protection Ref. 1910.305(b)(1)(i)	Conductors entering cutout boxes, cabinets and fittings are protected from abrasion.	☐	☐	☐	
12	Entry openings closed Ref. 1910.305(b)(1)(i)	Openings where conductors enter are effectively closed around them.	☐	☐	☐	
13	Unused openings closed Ref. 1910.305(b)(1)(ii)	No open knockouts or holes in cabinets, boxes or fittings; every unused opening is effectively closed.	☐	☐	☐	
14	Cables secured Ref. 1910.305(b)(1)(iii)	Each cable is secured to its cabinet, cutout box or meter socket enclosure, or meets every condition of the exception in the clause.	☐	☐	☐	
15	Pull and junction box covers Ref. 1910.305(b)(2)(i)	Every pull box, junction box and fitting has a cover identified for the purpose in place; metal covers are grounded.	☐	☐	☐	
16	Outlet box covers Ref. 1910.305(b)(2)(i)	In completed installations, every outlet box has a cover, faceplate or fixture canopy.	☐	☐	☐	
17	High-voltage box marking Ref. 1910.305(b)(3)(iii)	Covers of pull and junction boxes on systems over 600 volts, nominal, carry a permanent, legible "HIGH VOLTAGE" marking on the outside.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION C | Switches, panelboards and wet-location enclosures

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
18	Knife switch orientation Ref. 1910.305(c)(1)	Single-throw knife switches are placed so gravity will not tend to close them.	☐	☐	☐	
19	Snap switch faceplates Ref. 1910.305(c)(4)	Faceplates on flush snap switches completely cover the box opening and sit against the finished surface.	☐	☐	☐	
20	Switchboards with exposed live parts Ref. 1910.305(d)(1)	Any switchboard with exposed live parts is in a permanently dry location and can be reached only by qualified persons.	☐	☐	☐	
21	Panelboards enclosed and dead front Ref. 1910.305(d)(2)	Panelboards sit in cabinets, cutout boxes or enclosures designed for the purpose and are dead front, or else can be reached only by qualified persons.	☐	☐	☐	
22	Damp and wet location enclosures Ref. 1910.305(e)(1)	Enclosures in damp or wet areas keep water out, sit with at least 6.35 mm (0.25 in.) airspace from the wall unless nonmetallic on concrete, masonry, tile or similar, and are weatherproof in wet locations.	☐	☐	☐	
23	Wet location switchgear Ref. 1910.305(e)(2)	Switches, circuit breakers and switchboards in wet locations are in weatherproof enclosures.	☐	☐	☐	

General guidance only, not legal advice. Check the current regulation and your employer's procedures.

SECTION D | Temporary wiring

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
24	Permitted purpose Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(i)	Temporary wiring of 600 volts, nominal, or less serves remodeling, maintenance or repair; Christmas decorative lighting, carnivals or similar purposes for no more than 90 days; or experimental, development or emergency work.	☐	☐	☐	
25	Removed when finished Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(ii)	No temporary wiring left in place after its project or purpose has ended.	☐	☐	☐	
26	Conductors off the floor Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(v)(C)	No branch-circuit conductors are laid on the floor.	☐	☐	☐	
27	Grounding-type receptacles Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(vi)	Every receptacle on temporary wiring is a grounding type and is electrically connected to the grounding conductor.	☐	☐	☐	
28	Equipment grounding conductor Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(vi)	Each temporary branch circuit has a separate equipment grounding conductor, unless it is installed in a continuous grounded metallic raceway or metallic covered cable.	☐	☐	☐	
29	Means of disconnection Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(viii)	Each temporary circuit has disconnecting switches or plug connectors that cut all ungrounded conductors.	☐	☐	☐	
30	Lamp guards Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(ix)	Lamps for general illumination are in a fixture or lampholder with a guard against contact or breakage.	☐	☐	☐	
31	Cords protected from damage Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(x)	Cords and cables are kept clear of sharp corners, projections, doorways and other pinch points.	☐	☐	☐	
32	Cords supported Ref. 1910.305(a)(2)(xi)	Cords and cable assemblies are held in place by staples, cable ties, straps or similar fittings that do not damage them.	☐	☐	☐	

SECTION E | Fixtures, receptacles and general-use equipment

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
33	No exposed live parts on fixtures and receptacles Ref. 1910.305(j)(1)(i)	Fixtures, lampholders, lamps and receptacles have no live parts exposed to contact, except permitted terminals at least 2.44 m (8.0 ft) above the floor.	☐	☐	☐	
34	Portable handlamps Ref. 1910.305(j)(1)(ii)	Cord-connected handlamps have a molded or identified handle and a substantial guard on the lampholder or handle.	☐	☐	☐	
35	Handlamp lampholders Ref. 1910.305(j)(1)(ii)	No portable handlamp uses a metal shell, paper-lined lampholder.	☐	☐	☐	
36	Plugs and connectors Ref. 1910.305(j)(2)(i)	15- and 20-ampere plugs and connectors show no current-carrying parts other than the prongs, blades or pins.	☐	☐	☐	
37	Grounding plugs in grounding receptacles Ref. 1910.305(j)(2)(iii)	No grounding-type plug is used in a nongrounding-type receptacle or connector.	☐	☐	☐	
38	Wet location receptacles for unattended loads Ref. 1910.305(j)(2)(vi)	Receptacles in wet locations serving unattended products have enclosures that stay weatherproof with the plug inserted or removed.	☐	☐	☐	

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SECTION E | Fixtures, receptacles and general-use equipment

No.	Check item	What to look for	OK	Defect	N/A	Notes
39	Appliance nameplates Ref. 1910.305(j)(3)(iii)	Each electric appliance has a nameplate with its identifying name and rating in volts and amperes or volts and watts.	☐	☐	☐	
40	Motor disconnect position Ref. 1910.305(j)(4)(iv)	Each motor disconnecting means plainly shows whether it is open (off) or closed (on).	☐	☐	☐	
41	Transformer vaults clear Ref. 1910.305(j)(5)(viii)	No material stored inside transformer vaults.	☐	☐	☐	
42	Battery ventilation Ref. 1910.305(j)(7)	Storage battery areas have diffusion and ventilation that prevent gases building up into explosive mixtures.	☐	☐	☐	

DEFECTS FOUND AND ACTION TAKEN

Item no.	Defect description	Reported to	Action taken / date closed

SIGN-OFF

SAFE TO OPERATE? ☐ Yes ☐ No: tagged out of service	
INSPECTOR SIGNATURE	DATE / TIME
SUPERVISOR REVIEW	DATE / TIME